wounded and the dying, while in some cases soldiers who had been captured were lined up and shot in cold blood.

Meanwhile 13 Dogra positions at Senge Dzong were gradually being pushed back by the advancing Chinese troops who were now coming across Se-la. By last light on 18 November Lieutenant Colonel M. S. Oberoi was fully aware that both the vehicle and infantry columns had been completely annihilated. Unable to link up with either 4 Sikh LI or 4 Garhwal Rifles, the battalion, under the cover of darkness, broke contact with the Chinese and in small parties along with elements of the brigade staff made their way down from Senge. The Chinese were, however, waiting for them and had lit up the entire area with Very lights and quite a few men were killed near the Tammapha Chu as they tried to climb the opposite slopes. However, a good proportion of the Dogras managed to get across the southern range into Bhutan. In relative terms, considering the fact that 13 Dogra had been deployed at Zimithang, Tawang and then Se-la, the battalion got out of NEFA in reasonably good order.

On the Nyukmadong-Dirang Dzong axis 4 Garhwal Rifles ran into lighter Chinese opposition, though they too lost a few men and a couple of officers as they were ambushed and harassed by small Chinese parties. The remnants, about 250 men under Lieutenant Colonel Bhattacharjea reached Bridge 1 at 3 a.m., a couple of hours after 4 Rajput had withdrawn from there. Instead of following Avasthy's route towards the Manda-la heights, Bhattacharjea was still looking at linking up with 4 Division HQ at Dirang Dzong. Just short of Dirang, the Garhwalis ran into what they believed to be another Indian column heading in the same direction. However, it soon became obvious that 4 Garhwal had walked into Chinese captivity. The battalion had lost 3 officers, 4 JCOs and 153 ranks during the ill-fated withdrawal after the Battle of Nuranang that had been fought thirty-six hours previously. Five officers including the commanding officer, 8 JCOs and 251 Garhwalis were captured by the Chinese.

Once the decision to abandon Se-la had been taken, 4 Sikh LI found itself cut off. It had fought numerous rearguard actions as it extricated itself from the southern face of the Se-la massif, eventually getting down to the Senge-Dirang road. However, by then, the main body of the brigade had already moved on. At this juncture, the battalion ran into a small Chinese force that it eliminated, even taking a couple of prisoners in the process. However, it was constantly harassed by pursuing troops and continued to